ELIXIR-UK Data Stewardship Fellowship Programme

Perez-Sitja, Xenia[1]; Andrews, Robert[2]; Khalil, Sara[1]; Franicevic, Branka[1]; Knox, Catherine[5]; Andrabi, Munazah[3]; Sufi, Shoaib[3]; Sansone, Susanna-Asunta[4]; Goble, Carole[3]; Poterlowicz, Krzysztof[1]
1: University of Bradford – ELIXIR-UK, UK; 2: University of Cardiff – ELIXIR-UK, UK; 3: University of Manchester – ELIXIR-UK, UK; 4: University of Oxford – ELIXIR-UK, UK; 5: Earlham Institute –ELIXIR-UK, UK

The project behind the Fellowship

In 2021, ELIXIR-UK was granted a UKRI award for the ELIXIR-UK DaSH project. The University of Bradford leads the project with a delivery team at Cardiff University, the Earlham Institute, the University of Manchester, and the University of Oxford.

The project aims to embed **Research Data Management (RDM)** know-how into UK universities and institutes by producing and delivering training in Data Stewardship. It focuses on building capacity and professionalising the role of Data Stewards while leveraging the local expertise within diverse UK organisations.

Ultimately, the project aims to create a culture change with a Fellowship of Data Stewards. Fellows will act as ambassadors to embed RDM in their organisations

Embedding RDM and FAIR principles

The project enables Fellows to contribute to two international RDM resources, gaining knowledge on the latest best practice and guidance and preparing them for advocacy to their own institutions and research areas.

Editors of the RDMkit, a community-led guide to data management, are part of the team of advisors and coordinators of the projects.

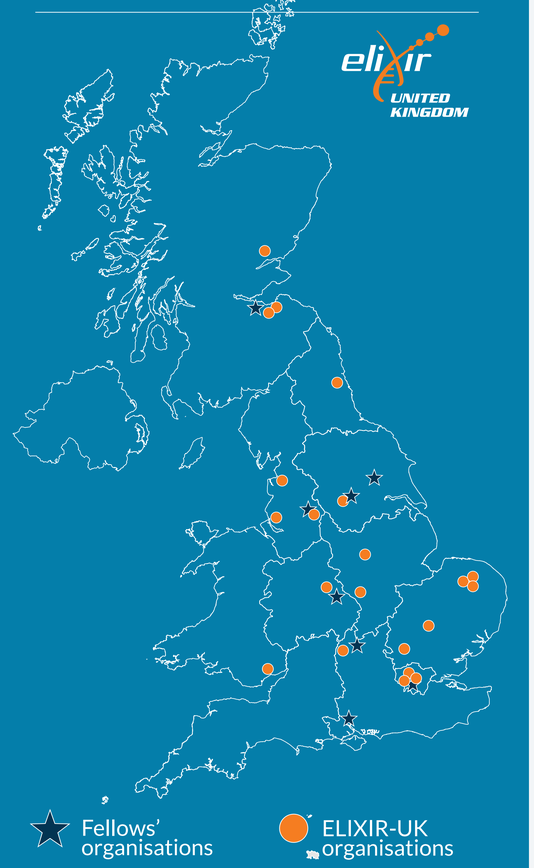
The project engages with the FAIR Cookbook, a practical step-by-step guide on implementing the FAIR principles (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable).

This project was funded as part of the UKRI Innovation Scholars: Data Science Training in Health and Bioscience call (DaSH). (MR/V038966/1)

The sustainability of the Fellowship

The Fellowship has the support of ELIXIR-UK. Numerous experts in bioinformatics and computational biology form the connections that build this UK infrastructure for life sciences data.

21 UK universities and institutes are currently part of ELIXIR-UK



Additionally, the connection of ELIXIR-UK with the Software Sustainability Institute (SSI) informs the Fellowship's structure, processes and results. SSI has been running a successful fellowship for more than 10 years. The collaboration inspires best practices and avoids common pitfalls in running and building a community of practice.

The Fellowship: activities, goals and Fellows

The ELIXIR-UK DaSH Fellowship lies at the project's core and drives its main goals and achievements.

High quality and diversity

The Fellowship welcomes experts in data management in life sciences at any career stage, from PhD candidates to professors, and from any life sciences field.

The Fellows are a select group of data stewards. A panel of experts scrutinises applications in two stages: shortlisting and selection. All candidates must demonstrate a strong understanding of data management in their niche area and excellent communications skills to deliver training.

The work of the Fellows is also carefully reviewed. Together with an expert pool from ELIXIR-UK and beyond, the project team ensures that the content meets the quality standards for training delivery, accuracy and relevance.

The Fellowship produces factual, up-to-date and enticing RDM training

The resources developed

VIDEO BITES

Short videos of 3-5 minutes on RDM aspects within Fellows' fields of expertise. These videos focus on relating basic concepts or signposting larger pieces of work.

TRAINING COURSES

Content for face-to-face and online courses on RDM and FAIR data. Fellows can work solo or in collaboration with other Fellows and trainers, using infrastructure that allows for reusability and scalability, such as The Carpentries.

The benefits

GENERATING RDM CAPACITY LOCALLY

Being part of the Fellowship entails organising training courses within the Fellow's institution or communities using material developed in the Fellowship,

SEEDING A LOCAL COMMUNITY OF PRACTICE

Delivering training courses locally and disseminating training materials helps get interested parties together. The activities of the Fellowship aim to help build the grassroots of a local community of practice.

ENHANCING TRAINING SKILLS

Fellows also benefit from ELIXIR training courses, including Train-the-Trainer and coaching relationships with other Fellows and trainers.

CONTRIBUTING TO INTERNATIONAL PROJECTS

Because the Fellowship is engrained in ELIXIR-UK, Fellows can contribute to RDM best practices and know-how in international resources: FAIR Cookbook, RDMkit.

The first cohort of ELIXIR-UK DaSH Fellows

Annabel Cansdale
Bioinformatician
University of York

Laura Cooper
Research Fellow
University of Warwick

Rob Ewing
Associate Professor
University of Southampton

Elvina Gountouna
Research Data Manager
University of Edinburgh

Korneel Hens
Senior Research Fellow
Oxford Brookes University

Katarzyna Kamieniecka
PhD Candidate
University of Bradford

Emma Karoune
Research Associate
The Alan Turing Institute

Saskia Lawson-Tovey
Health Data Scientist/ Engineer
University of Manchester

Andrew Mason
Research Fellow
University of York

CALL FOR APPLICATIONS IS NOW OPEN

Deadline: 10 July 2022

October 2022-October 2023
£3,000 honoarirum (subject to tax)
UK-based candidates
All career stages